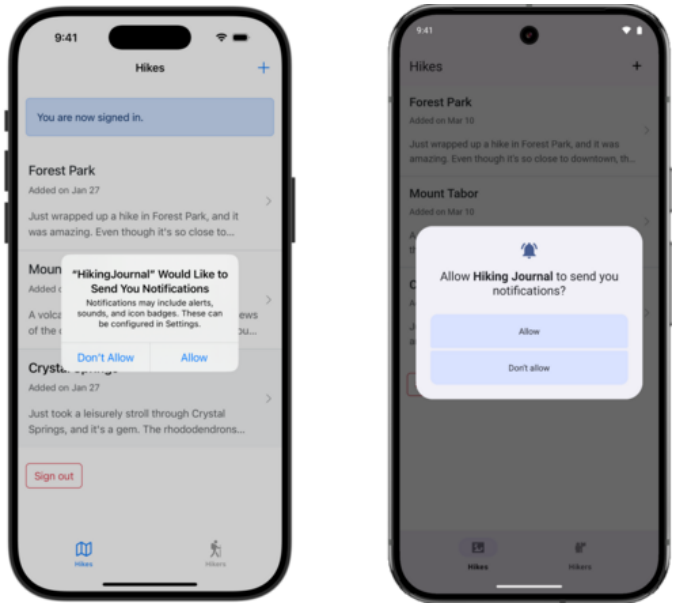
Send Push Notifications from Ruby on Rails

To send a user a push notification, you first need the user's permission to do so. This is triggered by a call to a native API that then presents a system dialog, shown as follows. If the user accepts, the system provides us with a *notification token* unique to the device.



You'll transfer this token to your Rails server and use the Noticed gem[75] to communicate with APNs and FCM. These services will then send the notification to the device, identified by its token. It's important to note that you don't directly send notifications to devices. You request APNs and FCM to do so via HTTP requests (abstracted by the Noticed gem).

Let's start with the Rails code. This section will walk you through the following steps:

1. Create a bridge component to trigger the native system dialog.
2. Create a notification token model and migration to persist tokens.
3. Add a route and controller to receive notification tokens.
4. Add the Noticed gem to send notifications.
5. Authenticate APNs.